

3.4 Operational management

Students should consider the following throughout this section of the specification:

- how developments in technology are affecting decision making and activities in operations (eg more online businesses, better links with customers, suppliers, inventory control, automation and robotics)
- ethical and environmental influences on operations decisions
- market conditions and competition
- how decisions in operations improve the competitiveness of a business
- the interrelationship between operational decisions and other functions.